

A QUIET ARGUMENT, IN THE SEASON OF BLOSSOMS

The virtue of virtue.

Why goodness is worth choosing for its own sake — and for no other.

ON THE VIRTUE OF VIRTUE

Virtue is not a means to something else — it is the thing itself.

We prize courage because it protects us, honesty because it earns trust.

But strip away every reward, and a virtuous act still shines.

The blossom does not bloom to be admired. It blooms because that is its nature.

ON THE VIRTUE OF VIRTUE
ARISTOTLE • NICOMACHEAN ETHICS

Flourishing is not virtue's reward — it is virtue in action.

eudaimonia

The good life *is* the virtuous life, lived — not a prize handed to the good, but the very shape of their days.

The classical virtues are not rules — they are ways of seeing.

Courage

Acting well in the presence of fear, not its absence.

Temperance

Wanting the right things, in the right measure.

Justice

Giving each their due, including the stranger.

Wisdom

Knowing which virtue this moment asks of you.

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We are what we repeatedly do. Excellence, then, is not an act, but a habit.

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Attributed to Aristotle, on the second nature of the good

ON THE VIRTUE OF VIRTUE

**Do good for a reward, and you have not been good —
you have been paid.**

The moment virtue becomes a transaction, it stops being virtue. The honest merchant who is honest only because it sells will lie the instant lying sells better.

Character is what remains when no one is keeping score.

ON THE VIRTUE OF VIRTUE

Two people keep a promise — only one of them is good.

THE MERCHANT

Weights the cost, finds it profitable, and pays. Change the price and the promise breaks.



THE GARDENER

Tends it because it is theirs to tend. No audit, no audience, no exception.

ON THE VIRTUE OF VIRTUE

Character is a garden — it is grown, not granted.

No one is born just, only capable of justice. Virtue is cultivation: small acts, repeated in season, until the good is not a decision but a disposition.

This is the patient art the East calls self-cultivation, and the blossom its yearly proof.

SENECA SAID IT PLAINER: VIRTUE IS ITS OWN REWARD.

Be good for nothing —
and you will have
everything.